



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Guidelines on the Use of Pepper Spray

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GUIDELINES FOR THE USE OF PEPPER SPRAY/ MACE

Objective

To provide a guideline for the use and accountability of the pepper spray/mace as an alternative to the firearm, consistent with the JCF Human Rights and Police Use of Force and Firearms policy.

Use of Force

1. Members of the JCF are equipped with various types of weapons and ammunition that would allow for a differentiated use of force and firearms. These include less lethal weapons for use in appropriate situations.
2. In addition to firearms, officers are issued with batons and incapacitating chemical sprays. The CS/CN weapon, pepper spray/mace is one such device.

Description

Pepper spray/mace is a non-lethal weapon system used by law enforcement, military and other organizations, and individuals. The device is used generally in the role of stand-off weapons, where physical proximity to a suspect is deemed dangerous but deadly force is not warranted. Although considered a non-lethal agent, it may be deadly in rare cases, hence adherence to directions for usage and particularly, appropriate training before issue is important.

Administrative procedure

1. Personnel must be trained and certified in the use of the mace before being issued.
2. The mace must be issued and signed for by the member in the Mace Keep and Care Register which will be instituted for this purpose.
3. Priority for issue must be given to trained members of the Operational Support Teams (OST), Patrol Teams, Traffic and Beat Duty Personnel.
4. An entry must be made in the station diary dispatching the member on duty with the mace on each occasion.
5. A comprehensive entry must be made in the station diary whenever the mace is used and a written report submitted to the member's immediate sub-officer.
6. If the mace is used under questionable circumstances, it is to be taken out of service, labelled and stored safely pending the outcome of the investigation and recommendation(s)
7. The divisional officer will ensure that monthly inspection of all mace is done and a return forwarded to the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Services Branch and copied to Superintendent of Police in charge of Headquarters Armoury.
8. Persons proceeding on transfers, extended leave, e.g. vacation leave, study leave etc. must return the mace to the Divisional Store.
9. Loss of the mace must be investigated in keeping with the JCF's established investigative procedures for lost firearms.